LESSON 5

City life – The advantages of urban living

Towns and cities appeal to people for a lot of reasons. Compared to the village or the countryside, there are more **job opportunities** in the cities, so a greater number of jobs is available. Besides, the **salaries are usually higher**, too. Big cities are more densely populated, which means that they can raise **more money for infrastructure**.

Infrastructure is often categorized as **hard** or **soft**. Hard infrastructure is the tangible, physical assembly of structures such as **roads, bridges, tunnels, and railways**. Soft infrastructure is the **services** required to maintain the economic, health, and social needs of a population.

The rush hour

A **rush hour** is a part of the day (early in the morning or late in the afternoon) during which traffic is at its heaviest. A lot of people are travelling to and from work so roads, buses and trains are very busy. Drivers get **stuck in traffic jams**, which makes their journey very stressful. Besides, it is difficult to find a place to park the car during the day if the **car park** is already full.

The streets are often **crowded**, **noisy** and **polluted**. Big cities can also be dirty and dangerous, and the crime rate is much higher than in smaller cities or villages.

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The nightlife

On the other hand, towns and cities offer a wide variety of **entertainment opportunities**. In the centre many bars, clubs and restaurants are within walking distance or accessible by public transport. The restaurants offer an endless variety of international cuisines. People interested in culture and cultural activities can go to the cinema, the theatre, concerts, art galleries, etc.

The advantages of urban living

Cities offer countless advantages, from vibrant nightlife to stimulating cultural activities. From **job opportunities** to **educational facilities**, there's no denying that big cities provide more choices for achieving your goals and dreams. Cities also often boast **higher salaries** compared to rural locations.

In the job market, cities offer more than just employment; they provide **career growth opportunities** unavailable elsewhere. There is a wide range of job opportunities for those seeking employment in the city.

Living in the city has many advantages, including **access to public transportation**. Public transit allows anyone to get around easily and quickly without worrying about finding a parking spot.

Cities provide unparalleled **educational opportunities** and resources for students who want to learn. Countless city schools offer various student resources such as **libraries**, **modern technology**, and **specialized courses**.

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City learning also provides access to remarkable educational facilities, including **museums**, **galleries**, **theatres**, and other **cultural sites**, all within walking distance from home. Furthermore, urban areas tend to have higher-than-average concentrations of universities and colleges than rural regions.

Big cities are full of well-stocked **stores**. From big-name brands to unique boutiques, the retail centres of major cities offer a great **variety of goods**.

In many cities, the food scene is fantastic. You have endless options for eating out, from **restaurants** run by famous chefs to **ethnic eateries** and **food trucks**. If the line is too long at one place, just walk down the street to find another one!

With numerous **medical facilities** available throughout any metropolitan area, people living in cities have ample opportunities for **quality health care** in case they need to find a primary physician or visit an urgent care centre on short notice.

ADVANTAGES	DISADVANTAGES
job opportunities, higher salaries	higher costs of living
better education opportunities and infrastructure	lack of parking
accessible public transportation	traffic jams
more cultural activities	dirty and dangerous districts
entertainment options variety of bars, clubs and restaurants	higher crime rates
shopping options	higher noise level
better access to healthcare facilities	various forms of pollution

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Opposites:

exciting/lively	dull/boring
clean (streets)	dirty (streets)
clean (air)	polluted (air)
quiet	noisy
safe	dangerous
stressful	calm

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